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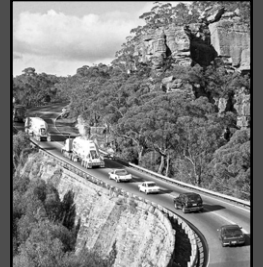
Wellington & District
LEADER
 Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharœna, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbron and Yeoval districts.
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PCYC gymnasts' Maitland success - P3



100 days, zero solutions - P6



Photo pages Redbacks & Warriors - P 14, 15, 16

Crazy decision

DUBBO Mayor Josh Black did not mince words labelling the speed reduction a “ridiculous decision from Sydney-based bureaucrats that doesn’t actually help people out here”.

From Binjang Radio and WDL

THE NSW State Minister for Roads and Minister for Regional Transport is under fire yet again after cutting the Mitchell Highway speed limit between Wellington and Dubbo from 110 to 100Kmph.

According to Member for Dubbo Dugald Saunders the decision was made without any consultation with the community and that Minister Aitchison had directed her department to secretly make this announcement online to avoid answering any questions, and without investing in what is actually needed long-term, to prevent more injuries and deaths from occurring.

Mr Saunders said focusing purely on speed was short-sighted, and what was needed was proper investment in the road. “This isa band-aid solution that won’t fix things long term.

“This part of the Mitchell Highway is a crucial link for residents, workers, producers, businesses and tourists alike, and it’s disappointing the Minister for Roads has not fronted up to hear directly from those who rely on it most,” Mr Saunders said.

Dubbo mayor Josh Black did not mince words, labelling the speed reduction a “ridiculous decision from Sydney-based bureaucrats that doesn’t actually help people out here”.

Cr Black argued the root cause of the highway’s danger wasn’t the 110kmph speed limit itself, but the severe lack of investment over the past 15 years, leaving drivers with no safe places to pass due to the lack of overtaking lanes.

Transport for NSW executive director Damien Pfeiffer justified the decision citing safety concerns.

Transport modelling suggests the 10kmph reduction could cut fatalities by 27 per cent and serious injuries by 21pc, while adding “less than a minute” to the average commuter’s journey.

The accuracy of the modelling has not been confirmed.

The news of the speed limit changes comes after an incident just last month on the Mitchell Highway, south of Wellington, involving a truck and four cars, which left multiple people injured.

That section of road is posted at 100kmph.

The changes are due to come into effect on June 22nd.

...See Opinion column Page 2.



Inside this week

Auditor-General exposes failures in state government’s water reform agenda - Page 13

Where are our overtaking lanes?

THE ANNOUNCEMENT by Transport for NSW of the speed limit reduction on the Mitchell Highway between Wellington and Dubbo that starts next Monday is symptomatic of a much longer-term wider disregard for our region from successive State and Federal Governments of all political persuasions.

Four new overtaking lanes could have been built at any time in the past 15 years by any State government but weren't.

Reducing the speed limit is a typical Sydney-based bureaucratic decision to the problem of too many crashes on that stretch of road.

But it is only treating the symptom.

Everyone who drives that road knows that for the past 15 years we have needed many more overtaking lanes built.

The problem is caused by not there not being enough safe passing opportunities, drivers are frustrated being stuck in a convoy behind a much slower bus/caravan/truck/ute, and then undertake a risky overtaking manoeuvre at 130+km/h.

Dropping the speed limit to 100 km/h simply won't stop this from occurring.

The Sydney bureaucracy would have us all driving around at 60km/h so that they don't have to spend \$40m on some overtaking lanes, whilst at the same time reducing the road toll.

A stat that puts the road toll into perspective is that last year in Australia the deaths due to drug overdoses were double the deaths on the road.

Where is the same obsession and intervention strategies?

I've watched with some bemusement as numerous overtaking lanes were constructed on the Mitchell Highway between Dubbo and Narromine.

It is now a safe stretch of road with ample passing opportunities.

I question the decision to construct these prior to constructing an additional four overtaking lanes between Wellington and Dubbo which carries a far higher amount of traffic each day.

I've written to the Minister responsible and await the reply.

However, the general level of disrespect with which people in our region are treated by the Sydney bureaucracy is galling.

The RFS 'Red Fleet' moves to the State Government – finally!

And now to some fantastic news from the NSW Government, and in particular the Premier, Minister Dib and Minister Hoenig.

In a win for everyone it has just been announced that from 1 July 2027, the NSW Government is going to move the 6000+ RFS trucks and vehicles, known as the "Red Fleet", off the books of local councils and onto the state Government.

It has never been fair that councils are financially responsible for depreciating assets that we don't control.

This is the result of a campaign run since 2002 by the former Shires Association, and the current NSW Country Mayors Association, in conjunction with the Local Government NSW Association.

I'm proud to say that I am a board member of each of those peak bodies who advocate relentlessly for the betterment of councils in NSW. The announcement by the Minns Government makes total sense in that the RFS vehicles will now be under the auspices of the RFS and the State Government, as it is the RFS who actually operates them.

This change will finally align reality with

accountability and will hopefully result in better equipment and maintenance for the very important volunteers who deserve the best support that we can give them.

From a council perspective, moving these assets off the books is a big win for regional, rural and remote councils who are all doing it tough financially.

Not having to maintain and depreciate RFS assets will allow more ratepayer funds to be put into core council business.

The NSW Government will invest more than \$29 million over two years to establish up to eight RFS regional maintenance hubs and providers (hopefully one in our LGA), \$106 million over four years for critical maintenance and safety upgrades, and \$470 million to move the assets across.

The investment in regional maintenance hubs will support local jobs and apprenticeships, and I have already written to Minister Dib and the RFS with a proposal to house one in our region.

This reform is a practical step forward - backing our emergency services, strengthening regional economies, and taking pressure off local government where it's needed most.

...Josh Black

Editorial

Highway speed drop a crazy decision

IN JUST another example of how out of touch the state's transport department is; it decides to lower the speed limit on the Mitchell Highway from 110 to 100 kilometres per hour – effective from June 22.

It says the lower speed limit is due to safety issues.

If the department boffins bothered to look at their work schedule, they would have seen that the highway from Geurie to near Wongarbon (Deep Creek works) has roadwork speeds down to 80 and 60kph for the past several months.

Those speeds are definitely for safety reasons as there is road upgrading works being carried on as well as coaxial cable laying and now new power poles for the increased electricity loads to come – all along this section of the Mitchell Highway.

Traffic can be stopped for up to 20 minutes, and by the look of things, progress will be slow for some months ahead.

This begs the question – if roadworks is slowing traffic, what is the 10kph drop in maximum speed limit going to do to an already slow traffic section?

Previous state Labor governments back to Bob Carr's premiership supported rural areas as there was a 'Country Labor' contingent speaking up for rural and regional areas.

Not so the Minns Government.

The 110kph limit was raised back in the Carr government days mainly due to work done by Wellington's Tony Kelly, a former Wellington Shire Council general manager prior to be called to the state's Legislative Assembly and later holding several ministerial portfolios.

Geurie district residents have been fighting the transport department for more than a year for a new bridge to replace the wooden Scabbing Flat bridge, and getting nowhere.

People are wondering why the Minns government still has a regional NSW ministry.

The way rural and regional people have been put on the back-burner by this government makes one wonder for how much longer will Labor's dyed-in-the-wool supporters and voters support it.

Mark Griggs
Editor

Heritage protections covering GWH convict bridge

By Binjang Radio

HERITAGE PROTECTIONS are holding up the repairs to the Mitchells Causeway convict bridge traffic pinchpoint along the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass.

The Causeway's inclusion on the State Heritage Register has complicated remediation, as any substantial reconstruction or structural alteration requires formal approval from the Heritage Council of NSW.

This means bespoke engineering solutions must be vetted for their impact on the 200-year-old stone fabric, buttresses, and internal rubble fill.

While a specific Exemption Order exists for minor or routine maintenance on the structure, the severity of the geotechnical failure and bulging sandstone walls means that emergency stabilisation works fall outside these allowances, requiring specialised heritage consultants to assess every proposed construction methodology.

The NSW Government and Transport for NSW have shortlisted two major engineering consortia to design and deliver the emergency remediation of Mitchells Causeway at Victoria Pass: Seymour Whyte and Gamuda.

Timelines to completion of works re-

mains uncertain.

Whilst Minister Jenny Aitchison continues to portray the matter as a safety issue and it has become exactly that, regional motorists and transport operators are more concerned by the high cost-patchwork maintenance and the neglect of this section of road by successive governments, averse to funding engineering solutions for this geo-technically difficult section of the highway.

The causeway is a major traffic pinchpoint along the Great Western Highway, with dual lane carriageways converging into single lanes as they cross the bridge.

Motorists are saying that neither Victoria Pass nor the NSW Heritage Act 1977 is fit for purpose.

The Heritage act 1977 introduced by the Wran Labor Government also remains a point of contention in what is seen by locals as being applied by the Minns Labor Government in a con-fected manner, to the replacement of a new fit for purpose Scabbing Flat Bridge at Geurie.

From Tuesday, June 9 to Friday, July 10, road users can expect delays of up to 15 minutes at the traffic lights at Scabbing Flat Bridge to replace several large timbers below the bridge deck.

Obituaries of our loved ones
are welcomed for publication
in the "Leader"

Contact:

mark@wdleader.news

Preloved book shop has new home

Lions' preloved bookshop will have a new home in early July.

The club is so grateful to the owners of Kimbell's Kitchen who have enabled the book shop to continue after having to move out of the old Western Stores building.

A larger space with easy access has been acquired at 9/10 Namina Crescent (opposite the Commonwealth Bank) with plans to open in the second week of July.

The Kimbell's Kitchen venue closed on June 13. Keep an eye out in this paper and on the Lions' facebook page for more details so you can choose your reading matter for this cold weather when the preloved book shop reopens.

Some volunteers to help us move would be greatly appreciated.

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharéena to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Farming women get down and dirty

On LAST Friday’s chilly and wet winter day 25 local ladies gathered on a hillside to ‘Talk Dirty’ with each other.

This new Landcare initiative brought farming women together to learn how to assess soil health in the paddock and help them understand the flow on impacts to farm production and family health.

Dr Aurelie Quade from Soil Resilience in Mudgee led the workshop and emphasised the importance of soil health as it underpins everything for agricultural businesses.

“Don’t worry at night if it’s going to rain,” she explained to the group “be sleepless over the state of your aggregates.

“Because your aggregate health will determine how well you can utilise the rain when it falls.”

Local Landcare Coordinator Deb Cooke said it was great to be out with a group of women who wanted to skill up in this area.

“We want women to feel confident being part of the conversation when they are at the table and decisions are being made about paddock management.”

Mid Macquarie Landcare and Little River Landcare groups are also currently offering subsidised soil testing for local producers and assistance with soil test interpretation as well as pasture grazing management training before the end of the year (part of the NSW Landcare Enabling Program, a collaboration between Local Land Services and Landcare NSW supported by the NSW Government).

To take part in these and other great Landcare projects you can reach out via info@mml.org.au, 0457 115 525 or via the @Mid-MacLandcare Facebook page



Tessa Ponder, Kate Kiss, Rebecca Parkes and Olivia Atkinson test their new skills on their own soil samples while Susie Wright and Lindy Carney supervise.

PCYC gymnastics success at Matiland



WELLINGTON PCYC’s amazing gymnasts, the Sassy Cats travelled to Maitland PCYC last weekend to compete at the Winter Challenge.

It was a great day of Team Gym, and the girls came away with Silver.

The Wellington club gives a huge shout-out to Maitland PCYC for putting the competition together and thanks to all of the parents and family members who went along to cheer the girls on.

LEFT: Sassy Cats won Silver medals at the Maitland PCYC Challenge.

LEFT: Aurelie Quade assists Rebecca Parkes, Olivia Atkinson, Lucy Cook and Emily Fryett to assess soil in the field, assisted by RHAMP Coordinator Gabrielle Schultz.

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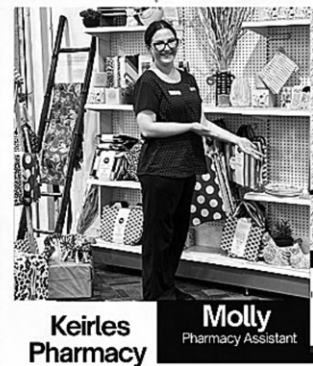


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We need more overtaking lanes
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HELLO FROM Wellington Arts Centre (WACI)

While work progresses on our new gallery space, we are busy behind the scenes and continuing to connect creativity across our community, providing opportunities for connection, whilst learning, sharing and having fun.

Our first ‘Sip and Paint’ was very popular with a great afternoon and hidden talents shining through.

Don’t miss out for our next Sunday Afternoon ‘Sip and Paint’ on July 12 at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club.

Details:<https://url.emailprotection.link/?bnVCmljHpY8YqqKw69etxixs-vUSzS1a01naC3AF9Xq9z2QTBpR6i13TTXZLzoZ30jTpSCoz0QMX1HZoBUp2m6Lg~~100> per cent beginner friendly.

WACI would like to thank everyone with gratitude, who has contributed so far to our Black Tie NON -EVENT successful fundraiser.

A very relaxed, no cost, no stress,

not happening, did not happen night that suited so many of us.

You can also find us at the Rotary Markets each month, showcasing the work of some of our talented local creatives.

Say Hi to us and hear information about WACI, with membership forms available, latest updates and progress on our new gallery, talk to talented local artists and maybe join our friendly volunteer team.

See you there!

FONG LEE LANE returns Friday, September 11 and is shaping up to be bigger and better.

Enjoy more food from around the world, the return of ‘The Good Luck Dragon’, an extraordinary musical line-up, and the chance to win great prizes of art supplies.

That’s just a small taste of what’s in store for our town Wellington from this much-loved iconic community event organised by Wellington Arts volunteer team.

We are also excited to launch a brand-new exhibition and competition in October titled ‘BIRD NERDS’. Keep an eye on this column and our social media pages for more details.

Whether you’re attending an event, supporting local artists or following the progress of our new gallery, Wellington Arts continues to plan and create many opportunities for our community and surrounds to connect with creativity.

The happy volunteer

Call for urgent JobKeeper style support for businesses impacted by Great Western Highway closure

LOCAL BUSINESSES across our region are facing a deepening crisis, with some now tragically forced to close their doors as a direct result of the disastrous indefinite closure of the Great Western Highway.

This is the shocking, human cost of this debacle. This is not a short-term disruption. We’re 100 days in and we’re looking at indefinite, forever roadworks. It’s an unfolding economic emergency. A regional crisis.

The business support package announced by the NSW Government is woefully and hopelessly inadequate.

Limited in scope and failing to extend beyond Hartley, it leaves many businesses and communities completely unsupported.

The current approach - offering small, one-off grants - is not just insufficient, it is an insult to hardworking business owners who are struggling to survive.

These minuscule payments do not keep doors open. They do not put food on the table for business owners, their staff, or their families.

With meetings and roadworks stretching on indefinitely and no clear end in sight, businesses are being asked to endure what is effectively a long-term shutdown without meaningful support.

This is simply unsustainable and utterly unacceptable.

What is needed is an ongoing, structured support package - similar to JobKeeper during the COVID-19 pandemic - that recognises the scale and duration of this disruption and provides real, continuing assistance to keep businesses afloat.

It is totally unacceptable that while governments continue to spend billions of dollars on major infrastructure projects in Sydney, communities on this side of the sandstone curtain are left behind - thrown a few crumbs, and expected to get by.

Government negligence and failure have caused this debacle, and it is only right that the response matches the scale of the damage now being inflicted on our communities.

I call on both the NSW and Federal Governments to urgently step up and deliver an ongoing business support package that reflects the severity of this debacle - before more businesses and jobs are lost and more residents and families are pushed to the brink.

Our communities deserve better.

My first speech competition

The My First Speech Competition is an exciting



The Gee Report

Andrew Gee
Federal Member for Calare

opportunity for young people in our school communities.

This is a national competition that welcomes students in Years 10, 11 and 12 to envision themselves as a newly elected Member of the House of Representatives and write a three-minute speech, focusing on a topic they’re passionate about.

One winner from each of year group will present their speech to the Speaker and members live at Parliament House, receiving an expenses-paid trip to Parliament House in Canberra, including flights and accommodation, and a prize pack valued at \$250.

As your Federal Member I highly encourage students in Years 10 to 12 to get involved!

This is a great competition to develop as our future local leaders – learning about the work of the Australian Parliament and gaining experience in writing and public speaking.

For further information and entry submission, please visit the website: <https://mfs.houseofrepresentatives.gov.au/>

Entries to the My First Speech Competition close on 11.59pm AEST on Monday 20 July 2026.

Good luck!

Australia Post grants

Applications are now open for the 2026 Australia Post Community Grants Program, offering grants of up to \$10,000 for community-led projects that help people connect and improve mental health and wellbeing in local communities.

An additional \$250,000 is available for projects supporting communities recovering from natural disasters or major storm events.

Eligible not-for-profit organisations are encouraged to apply.

Applications close: 6 July 2026 (11.59pm AEST).

For guidelines and eligibility information, visit <https://auspost.com.au/about-us/supporting-communities>

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Wellington & District

LEADER





with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

IT TOOK five years and \$3.1 billion to build 12 kilometres of tram track through the heart of Sydney.

The line opened in 2020 and, while many people love using it, I still struggle with the basic economics of the idea.

A tram is impressive, comfortable and efficient. But it can only go where the tracks go.

If there’s a special event somewhere else, bad luck. If a suburb grows in a different direction, bad luck again. The tram remains tied to its rails like a ship anchored to a jetty.

I’ve often wondered why a fleet of modern electric buses, perhaps with dedicated bus lanes during peak periods, wouldn’t offer more flexibility.

After all, \$3.1 billion would buy quite a few buses!

Now, I do understand the appeal of dedicated infrastructure when demand becomes enormous.

High-speed rail makes perfect sense to me.

Years ago, I rode the Shanghai Maglev train. Travelling over 400 km/h, it covered

the 30 kilometres from the airport into the city in just seven minutes.

When thousands of people need to move quickly between the same places every day, dedicated tracks become worthwhile.

But humans are endlessly creative.

What I had never considered was a bullet bus.

That sounds like something a child might invent after playing with toy cars and trains.

Yet transport planners in California are seriously exploring the idea.

The concept involves specially designed autonomous buses travelling at speeds up to 225 km/h on dedicated freeway lanes.

Suddenly, buses are competing with trains.

At first glance, it sounds fanciful. Buses are supposed to be the slow option. They stop often, weave through traffic and generally represent patience rather than speed. The idea is surprisingly simple.

Instead of laying thousands of kilometres of expensive railway track, build dedicated high-speed lanes alongside existing motorways. Then create a new generation of buses

designed specifically for those lanes.

These wouldn’t resemble the boxy buses we know today. Engineers envision sleek, lightweight vehicles built from advanced materials, shaped more like aircraft fuselages than city buses. Special tyres, powerful braking systems and sophisticated suspension would all be required. At 225 km/h, every design detail suddenly matters.

Perhaps the most interesting aspect is that these buses would likely drive themselves while travelling at high speed. Human reaction times simply aren’t quick enough for safe operation at those speeds.

The bullet bus represents a growing trend in technology: the blending of categories that once seemed separate.

Cars are becoming computers. Phones are becoming personal assistants. Drones are becoming delivery vehicles. Now buses are borrowing ideas from bullet trains.

The goal isn’t necessarily to replace rail.

In fact, many transport experts see high-speed buses as complementary.

Rail works brilliantly when connecting

major population centres. But buses have an advantage. Once they leave the high-speed corridor, they can continue directly on the existing road network.

Australia has already flirted with versions of this idea. Adelaide’s famous O-Bahn busway, opened in 1986, allows buses to travel on dedicated concrete guideways before returning to ordinary roads. Although the buses only travel up to 100 km/h, it is an innovative public transport system.

Of course, enormous challenges remain. Roads redesigned. Safety standards would be daunting. Public acceptance is another hurdle entirely. Some travellers already get motion sickness at suburban speeds.

Yet that’s often how the future arrives. Not through technologies we expect, but through combinations we never imagined.

The first cars looked like horse carriages. Early mobile phones resembled military radios. Now someone is asking whether a bus can behave like a bullet train.

Perhaps. Perhaps not. We may know the answer surprisingly fast.

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Warren

TRANSFERRED FROM Coonamble to Warren this year, the 1000 metres Cannonball was won by veteran sprinter Castlebar Road, locally owned by Harry Barclay.

The nine-year-old Castlebar Road had not won since early spring 2024 when taking out the Mendooran Cup and Coonamble Crystal Sprint however was showing signs of a return to form after a spell.

More recently trained at Mendooran by Jane Clement, Castlebar Road (\$7.50) ridden by 4g claiming apprentice Anna Weatherlake, followed the speedsters Chandon Star and Queensland visitor Mon Pierre in to the straight then sprinted to a good win by over a length from Crook (Zoe Hunt, \$3.60) and Mon Pierre (Jacob Stiff, \$3.50 favourite).

Royal Far West amplifies Little Wings call for urgent help

ROYAL FAR WEST supports Little Wings in its call for urgent, targeted funding support during the current fuel crisis, to ensure that they can continue supplying aeromedical transport services, especially to families in rural and remote communities.

Royal Far West partners with Little Wings through its Medical Wings program to deliver specialist outreach clinics directly into regional communities several times each year.

Little Wings also supports approximately 40 per cent of all families travelling to Royal Far West’s Centre for Country Kids in Manly, with three to five families relying on the service every week to access developmental assessments and therapy.

The current aviation fuel crisis has created extraordinary and unsustainable pressure on Little Wings’ operating costs.

Without urgent intervention, there is a real risk that flights may need to be reduced or suspended.

“The past few months have been really heartbreaking,” Clare Pearson, CEO of Little Wings, said.

“We are doing the best we can with the resources we have, but we’ve cut our capacity and will have to reduce our services even further if the avgas continues to go up.

“Little Wings eases the pressure on these families, and we become a part of their long-term journey. The fuel crisis is tearing that lifeline to shreds, leaving them without a backup, and we need swift support to keep our operations running,” she added.

“The consequences for rural and remote families would have an immediate impact,” Dr Briony Scott, CEO of Royal Far West, said.

“Delayed diagnoses, missed treatments, and reduced access to specialist services would widen existing inequities for children who already face significant challenges accessing care.”

The partnership between Royal Far West and Little Wings is critical in ensuring country children can access specialist care, regardless of where they live.

Zouch Street house razed in Saturday night’s fire

A HOUSE on Zouch Street was completely destroyed during a blaze on Saturday night June 13.

Authorities were called about 7.50pm with police and fire and rescue attending the scene where they found the home well alight as they set about extinguishing the blaze.

It has been confirmed that the home was unoccupied at the time of the fire.

A crime scene has been established, and police have commenced an investigation into the incident.

Castlebar Road has now taken the record to eight wins and 10 placings from 40 starts.

Trainer Jane Clement had earlier won the 1200m Women Of The West 2&3 year-old Maiden Handicap with Demarcate (Gabrielle Johnston, \$11) while she also had a winning double the previous day at Walgett with Adviser (Gabrielle Johnston) and Delrico ridden by Billy Cray in the Walgett Cup.

Having the first start for Gilgandra trainer Kieren Hazelton after previously being trained at Dubbo, Infinite Vixen (Serg Lisnny, \$26) came from midfield with an inside run to beat stablemate Jack The Boss (Mikayla Weir, \$8.50) and Fortians (Clay-

ton Gallagher, \$6) in the Women Who Built Western Racing Maiden Handicap.

After successive wins at Gilgandra and Tamworth before a spell, the Brett Robb trained It’s A Tata (Izzy Neale, \$4.40) was impressive when finishing best to win the 1000m Ladies Day Class 3 Handicap in a close finish from Bolo Miss (Mathew Cahill, \$5) and the leader Taormina Sailor (Angela Cooper, \$26).

From the Tamworth stables of Kevin Dixon, Uno Fred (Angel Brennan, \$8.50) was slowly away and came with a tremendous finish from many lengths last to grab a last-stride win in the 1600m Super Maiden Plate from Flee With Me (Gabrielle Johnston, \$7) and Lady Lilibet (Kody Nestor, \$8.50).

Todd Smith from Dubbo received a trainers licence only recently and has already led in three winners, Godwits at Quambone Picnics, The Confidante (Moree

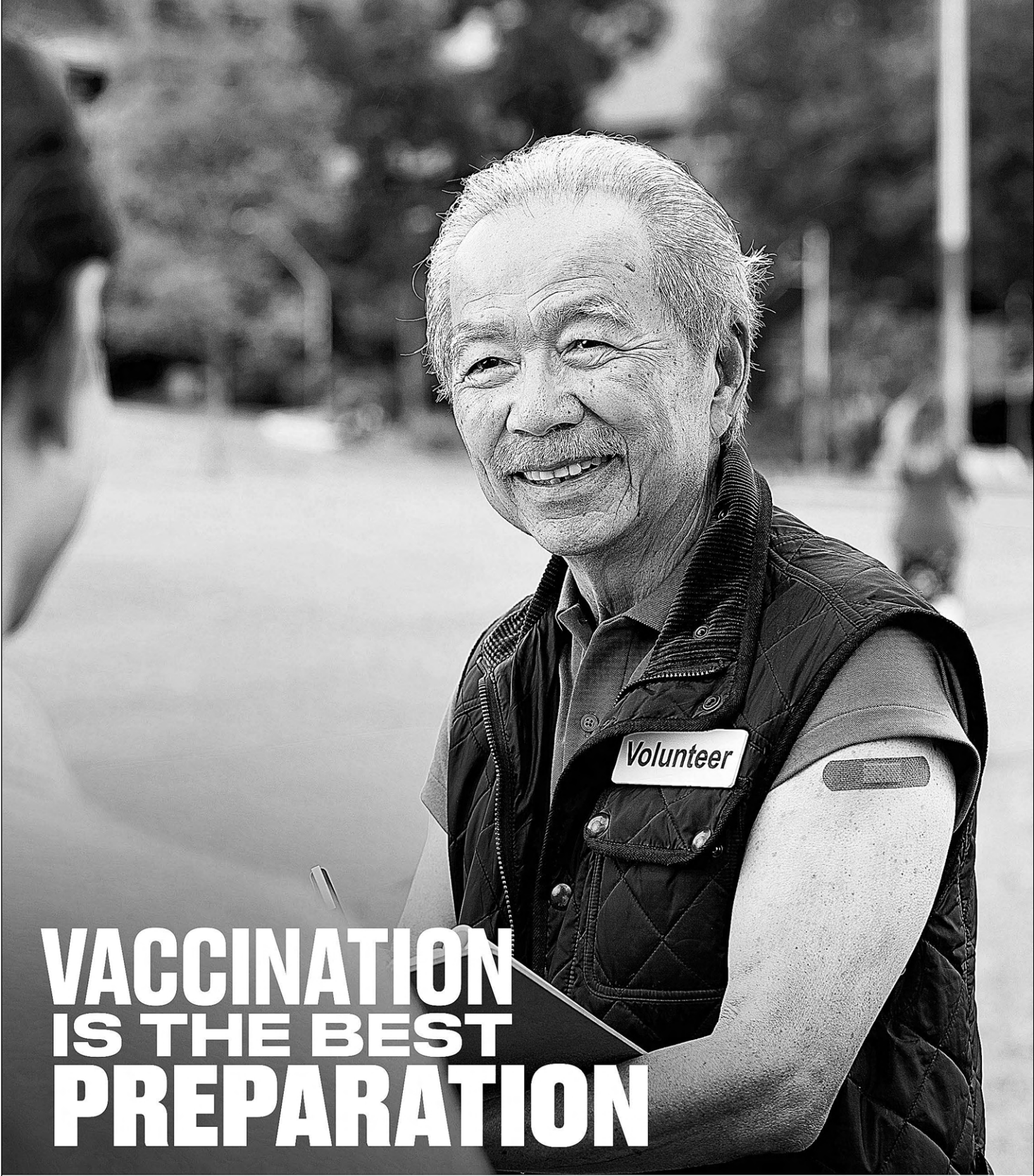
TAB) and Like Lukey at the Warren TAB meeting in the 1600m Heart Of Country Racing Benchmark 66 Showcase Handicap.

Liam Blanch has moved back to Dubbo and the young jockey has been given good opportunities by Todd Smith and rode Like Lukey very well.

Saving valuable ground along the rails from last early, Like Lukey (\$31) was switched to the outside entering the straight by Liam Blanch and ran home strongly to win by one-and-a-half lengths from Release Point (Kody Nestor, \$12) and Jasper’s Way (Jacob Stiff, \$2.15 fav.

Other winners were the Michael Mulholland trained Jamacri (Jacob Stiff, \$2.50 fav) and Yiasou (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$4.20) trained by Brett Thompson.

Racing on Saturday at Coonabarabran (TAB) and Talmoi Picnics and Monday June 22 at Narromine (TAB).



VACCINATION IS THE BEST PREPARATION

Influenza, COVID-19 and RSV viruses are always changing, and the risk of serious illness goes up if you’re over 65. By vaccinating regularly, you can protect yourself before a new strain goes around.

Speak to your health professional and book your vaccinations today or visit health.gov.au/winter-vaccinations



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Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

Promote your

Annual General Meetings

Social Club Events,

Birthday Parties

Homes and Flats to rent or wanted to rent

Lost and Found

Garage Sale

Memorium

Public Notice

Raffle prize winners

100 days, zero solutions: Labor abandons the Central West

WITH 100 days since the closure of the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass there has been 100 days of disruption, uncertainty and economic pain for families, freight operators, commuters and businesses across the Central West.

Shadow Minister for Regional Transport and Roads and Member for Bathurst Paul Toole said the Minns Labor Government had spent the last 100 days talking, studying and consulting while regional communities continue to pay the price.

“Labor has had 100 days and the people of the Central West are still waiting for action,” Mr Toole said.

“This is one of the most important freight and passenger corridors in NSW, yet Labor has failed to provide a clear timeline, failed to deliver a permanent solution and failed to properly support the communities carrying the burden.”

The closure of the Great Western Highway at Victoria Pass has forced motorists and heavy vehicles onto alternative routes, increasing travel times, adding to freight costs and reducing customer traffic for businesses throughout the Lithgow, Blue Mountains and Central West regions.

Businesses have reported reduced trading, letting go of staff and growing financial stress as customer numbers decline. Local operators have warned their businesses are becoming unviable under the prolonged closure.

Mr Toole said every extra kilometre travelled by a truck means higher freight costs, every family choosing not to make the trip means less money through the tills of local businesses, and every day this closure drags on means more damage to the regional economy.

Despite the closure beginning in March, it was months before the Government announced a modest assistance package for affected businesses.

“After 100 days of economic pain, the Minns

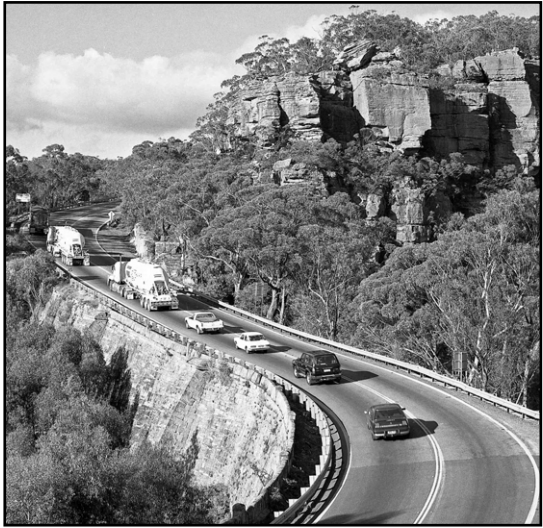


Photo: Neil Billington, Blue Mountains Library.

Labor Government’s response has been too little, too late.

“Minister Aitchison has no problems finding money for projects across Sydney and in her own electorate, yet the Central West has been left waiting for answers.”

Recent Labor funding announcements include \$156 million for road planning in North West Sydney and \$50 million for a bridge around the corner from the Minister’s home that the NSW Auditor-General found was awarded without a business case.

Mr Toole said the closure is not just a local issue but a statewide economic issue.

“The Great Western Highway is the gateway to the Central West. It connects producers to markets, workers to jobs, and visitors to regional communities.

“When that link is broken for 100 days, the consequences are felt right across regional NSW.

“Regional communities deserve better than excuses.”

Around the electorate

with our State Member Dugald Saunders

Slow move

TRANSPORT FOR NSW announced the 110km/h speed limit on the Mitchell Highway between Dubbo and Wellington will be reduced to 100km/h from 22 June.

While they’ve cited safety concerns for road users, Transport for NSW’s decision will be disappointing to anyone who uses this stretch of road.

Our region has long wanted to see proper investment to fix the condition of the road between Dubbo and Wellington, and to install more overtaking lanes to improve the overall flow of traffic on this major highway.

At the last NSW election, the Nationals and Liberals Coalition Government committed to doing just that if we were returned to government - building more overtaking lanes between Dubbo and Wellington.

It’s exactly what we committed at the 2019 election for the stretch of highway between Dubbo and Narromine; it’s been delivered and it’s working very well.

Unfortunately, the Coalition did not form government at the 2023 election, which meant that the Dubbo-Wellington project, along with the allocated funding, was shelved.

But perhaps what’s most disappointing is the

speed limit announcement was made under the cover of the departmental website, rather than by the Minister for Roads and Regional Transport.

If the decision was truly about safety, then surely the Minister herself would have made the announcement so she could spruik what a good job her government is doing.

Sign the Petition

While the Minister’s lips have remained sealed on the speed limit decision, the views of our community have been loud and clear: reducing the speed limit isn’t the only solution to safety on the Mitchell Highway.

Improving the road’s condition and building more overtaking lanes is just as important.

In light of this strong reaction, an e-Petition has been launched to urge the Minns Labor Government to commit to repairing and maintaining the road surface to an appropriate standard, deliver the overtaking lanes previously proposed for the corridor and acknowledge that these safety improvements would build on the already completed upgrades along the Mitchell Highway between Dubbo and Narromine.

To access the petition, you can visit my

Facebook and Instagram pages, my website www.dugaldsaunders.com.au or use the following link
<https://www.parliament.nsw.gov.au/la/Pages/ePetition-details.aspx?q=ZPXP0ooz0E7J7o8zNVN1CQ>

Fair go for the regions

On Friday the NSW Nationals announced the Coalition will bring back the Regional Seniors Travel Card if successful at the 2027 election.

First established by the former Coalition Government in 2020, the initiative provided 1.3 million eligible seniors in regional NSW with a \$250 prepaid card for fuel, taxis, and pre-booked train or coach tickets before being axed by the Minns Labor Government in 2023.

In the Dubbo Electorate, over 53,000 cards were issued to local seniors over the course of the program with \$5.93 million injected into the regional economy.

This card is all about making daily life easier for regional seniors and in a cost-of-living crisis, it’s needed now more than ever.

A re-elected Coalition has also committed to ensure that regional NSW gets its fair share of infrastructure funding with a Regional Infrastructure Guarantee of 25 per cent.

The Regional Infrastructure Guarantee will mean towns in regional NSW get their fair share when it comes to hospitals and schools, water infrastructure, roads rail and bridges.

Community grants

Australia Post’s Community Grants program is now open with grants up to \$10,000 available.

The program supports community initiatives across Australia that strengthen social connection and promote positive mental wellbeing.

Applicants can apply for grants up to \$10,000, with organisations unsuccessful in obtaining the full grant then able to be considered for a smaller grant of up to \$4000.

An additional \$250,000 in grant funding is also available to support projects that enhance mental wellbeing and build resilience in disaster-impacted communities.

Applications for locally-led and locally-delivered projects must be submitted by July 6. For more, visit: <https://auspost.com.au/about-us/supporting-communities/grants/community-grants-program>

Until next time, Dugald

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL

MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



BURRENDONG'S HIDDEN GEM



I had a wonderful time catching up with Sharon and Alicia from the Burrendong Botanic Garden & Arboretum.

Located just outside Wellington, this place is massive, 164 hectares of pure Australian wilderness overlooking the beautiful Lake Burrendong with over 50,000 native plants and 2,000 species.

Why not take a trip? Pack a picnic and explore, swing by the onsite nursery, and pick up your own native plants propagated onsite from local seedlings, take a piece of the arboretum home to your garden.

If you are local, volunteer with the community run team, it's a fantastic way to get active in nature, learn about plants, and look after these amazing Australian natives.

King's Birthday Honours List

Congratulations

Congratulations to all of our outstanding local residents who were awarded King's Birthday Honours for 2026!

This is very fitting and deserving recognition for all the important work they have done for our region, and the contributions they have made to our country.

John Cook OAM

of Orange for service to the community of Orange

Paul Griffiths OAM

of St Fillans (near Mudgee) for service to sport, to people with disability, and to the community

Paul Cavalier ASM

of Mudgee Australian Fire Service Medal

Greg Wells PSM

of Millthorpe Public Service Medal for outstanding public service to government service delivery in NSW

THE HUMAN COST OF GOVERNMENT NEGLIGENCE!



I'm with Rod and Anne Gurney who are closing their business on Main Street, Lithgow

Everyone says business must be booming with 12,000 cars passing daily, but the reality is terrible. Nobody is stopping, nobody is buying.

After 30 years, Rod and Anne have no choice but to close down. Their stress levels are through the roof and have less than a month to move out - all because of this whole Great Western Highway debacle.

WATCH MY FULL
VIDEO HERE



This is the human cost of this fiasco - right here on Main Street!

NSW and Federal Governments: How many more businesses have to close?

What is it going to take before you step up and take responsibility for this debacle?

How many more lives destroyed?

CALL FOR URGENT BUSINESS SUPPORT PACKAGE...NOW!

Tragically, our local businesses are now closing because of the disastrous Great Western Highway closure.

The business support package announced by the NSW Government is woefully and hopelessly inadequate and doesn't extend beyond Hartley.

Minuscule, one-off grants insult our communities and don't keep doors open and food on the table for our business owners, their staff and their families.

Because we're looking at forever road works with no end in sight, we need an ongoing support package like we had with JobKeeper during COVID.

Governments are spending billions on road projects on the other side of the sandstone curtain but insult our residents and businesses by throwing us a few crumbs and walking away.

Government negligence caused this and it's high time the government response reflected the damage that this debacle is inflicting on our communities.

Henry Lawson Festival Celebrates 50 Years

It was a massive crowd and the ongoing success of the festival is testament to the power of the Gulgong community!

Some of the many highlights included:

- Helping to present our young artists with their medals! Congratulations Sierra on your first place!
- Taking my '62 Ute in the huge street parade!
- Honouring Gulgong CWA for 100 years of outstanding service.
- Watching Henry cut his 159th birthday cake!

Thank you to Bill Murphy and his hardworking team of volunteers for bringing us this wonderful celebration of our history and of 50 years of magic!



Shout out to young Wellington High School student, Kekoa, who I bumped into when I was in Wellington, over the long weekend. Keep up the great work, Kekoa!



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🌐 www.andrewgeemp.com.au

For regular updates and news,
follow me on Facebook and
Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. 11.20 Dr Karl's How Things Work. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 The Capture. 2.00 Spicks And Specks. 2.30 Anh's Brush With Fame. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 4.00 Frankie Drake Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Restoration Australia. 9.00 Ground Up. 9.30 Twenty Twenty Six. 10.00 Rolf Harris: Primitime Predator. Final. 10.55 ABC Late News. 11.10 The Business. 11.25 Frankie Drake Mysteries. 12.10 Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Costi. 2.30 Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Father Brown. 8.30 Grace. Return. 10.30 Horse Racing. Royal Ascot. 3.30 Late Programs.

Entertains

1.15pm Elementary. 2.00 ER. 2.40 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 9.00 Gruen. 9.40 Late Programs.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Highway Patrol. 2.30 The Force: Behind The Line. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 AFL Pre-Game Show. 7.30 Football. AFL. Fremantle v Geelong. 11.00 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.30 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 5.30 Talking Tom Heroes. 6.05 Spidey And His Amazing Friends. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 8.40 Ultimate Vets. 9.05 Animal Park. 9.50 Secrets Of The Zoo. 10.35 Late Programs.

TV

6.00 News Breakfast. 9.00 ABC News Mornings. 10.00 Compass. 10.30 Stuff The British Stole. 11.00 Race Around The World. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 The Assembly. 1.45 Ground Up. 2.15 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 4.00 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Monty Don's British Gardens. New. 8.30 Shetland. 9.30 Twenty Twenty Six. 10.30 Gruen. 11.05 ABC Late News. 11.25 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. 12.10 Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Imagine Holidays Iconic Rail Journeys. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 The World's Most Scenic Railway Journeys. 8.30 Escape To The Country. 10.30 Horse Racing. Royal Ascot. 3.30 Late Programs.

Entertains

1.05pm Beyond Paradise. 2.00 ER. 2.45 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 MOVIE: Game Night. (2018) 10.10 Late Programs.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Timbersports. Aust C'ship Pt 2. Replay. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 AFL: Friday Night Countdown. 7.30 Football. AFL. Gold Coast Suns v Hawthorn. 10.30 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.15 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 5.30 Talking Tom Heroes. 6.05 Spidey And His Amazing Friends. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Gardening Australia Junior. 7.30 MOVIE: Scoob! (2020) 9.05 Caper Crew. 9.55 MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". 10.20 Merlin. 11.05 Late Programs.

TV

6.00 Rage Charts. 7.00 Weekend Breakfast. 9.00 Rage. 10.30 Rage Vault Guest Programmer. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Death In Paradise. 1.30 Shetland. 2.30 Shanghai Symphony Orchestra. 4.25 Stuff The British Stole. 5.00 Australian Story. 5.30 Landline. 6.00 Kath & Kim. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Death In Paradise. Final. 8.30 The Hardacres. 10.05 The Capture. 11.05 Rage.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Harry's Practice. 2.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 3.00 Secrets Of Beautiful Gardens. 4.00 Escape To The Country. 5.00 Dog Patrol. 5.30 The World's Most Scenic Railway Journeys. 6.30 Bondi Vet. 7.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 8.30 Lewis. 10.30 Horse Racing. Royal Ascot. 3.30 Late Programs.

Entertains

2.20pm ER. 3.05 A Bite To Eat. 3.35 QI. 4.05 Would I Lie To You? 4.35 MythBusters. 5.25 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 6.15 Grand Designs NZ. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. 9.20 Live At The Apollo. 10.05 Late Programs.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Lady Torque TV. 2.00 Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. 3.00 Motor Racing. National Drag Racing C'ship. Top Doorslammer. Riverbend Nationals. 4.00 Football. AFL. GWS Giants v Carlton. 7.00 Storage Wars. 7.30 MOVIE: Back To The Future. (1985) 10.00 MOVIE: Battleship. (2012) 12.40 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 5.10 Octonauts: Above And Beyond. 5.35 Super Monsters. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 Emerald. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 Kids Baking Championship. 8.10 Kids BBQ Championship. 8.55 Caper Crew. Final. 9.40 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.25 Abbott Elementary. 10.45 Late Programs.

5x5 No. 396

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

M		S		S
	T		I	
K		A		A
	N		E	
R		E		S

Edgeword No. 248

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

LE

RY

TA

WD

UR

SO

NA

CE

There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath No. 246

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

	×		−		=	5
×		+		+		
	+		−		=	7
−		−		−		
	+		×		=	16
=		=		=		
3		11		0		

Solutions

TAWDRY
CELERY
SONATA
SOURCE

EDGEWORD

S	D	E	R
R	E	N	E
A	L	A	O
C	I	T	A
S	T	S	M

SXS

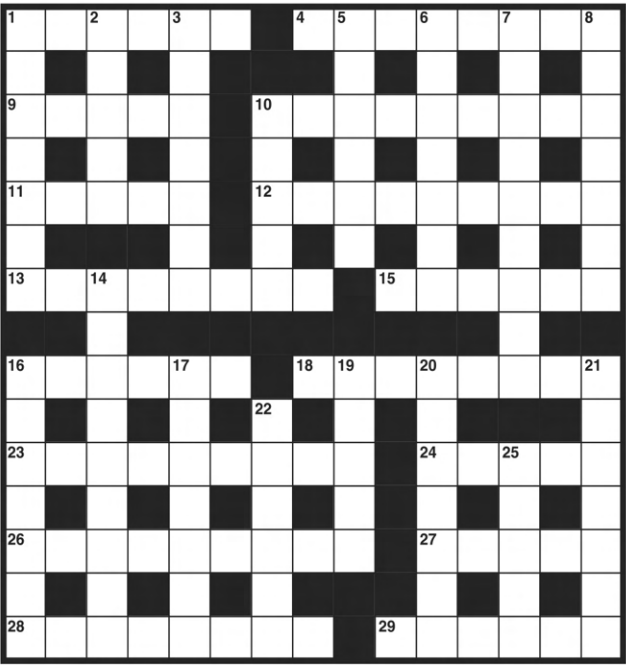
	0		11		3	
	=		=		=	
91	=	6	×	1	+ 7	
		−		−	−	
7	=	9	−	8	+ 5	
		+		+	×	
5	=	3	−	4	×	2

HTAWSSOROC

7 9 7TV 6.00 Rage. 7.00 Weekend Breakfast. 9.00 Insiders. 10.00 Offsiders. 10.30 The World This Week. 11.00 Compass. 11.30 Songs Of Praise. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Landline. 1.30 Monty Don's British Gardens. 2.30 Race Around The World. 3.30 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. 4.00 Restoration Australia. 5.00 Back Roads. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Compass. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Race Around The World. 8.30 Ground Up. 9.05 The Capture. 10.00 Death In Paradise. Final. 11.00 The Hardacres. 12.30 Rage. 3.00 Late Programs. two 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Your Money & Your Life. 1.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 The Surgery Ship. 3.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 4.30 My Greek Odyssey. 5.30 Australia's Amazing Homes. 6.30 Escape To The Country. 7.30 The Coroner. 8.30 Vera. 10.30 Malpractice. 11.30 Late Programs. Entertains 1.50pm ER. 2.35 My Family. 3.05 A Bite To Eat. 3.35 QI. 4.05 Would I Lie To You? 4.35 MythBusters. 5.25 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 6.15 Grand Designs NZ. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Amazing Spaces. 9.20 Race Around The World. 10.20 Late Programs.	7 9 7TV 6.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Sunday Footy Feast. 2.30 House Of Wellness. 3.30 The Salvation Army: Red Shield Appeal. 4.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Sydney Weekender. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Farmer Wants A Wife. 8.30 7NEWS Spotlight. 9.30 24 Hours In Police Custody. 12.05 Motor Racing. Supercars C'ship. Darwin Triple Crown. H'lights. 1.05 Harry's Practice. 2.00 Home Shopping. 3.30 Million Dollar Minute. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Late Programs. mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Mark Berg's Fishing Addiction. 2.00 Fishy Business. 2.30 AFL Pre-Game Show. 3.00 Football. AFL. St Kilda v Western Bulldogs. 6.00 Border Security: International. 7.00 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 8.30 MOVIE: Bad Boys II. (2003) Will Smith, Martin Lawrence. 11.30 Late Programs. Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.00 Play School. 3.25 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 3.50 Odd Squad. 4.25 Little J And Big Cuz. 5.15 Isadora Moon. 5.40 Super Monsters. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 Emerald. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 MOVIE: Fantastic Mr. Fox. (2009) 8.50 Animal Park. 10.20 Secrets Of The Zoo. 11.05 Late Programs.	9 9 9TV 6.00 Hello SA. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Wide World Of Sports. 11.00 NRL Sunday Footy Show. 1.00 GolfBarons. 1.30 Fish Forever. 2.00 Taronga: Who's Who In The Zoo. 3.00 Rugby League. NRL. Melbourne Storm v Canberra Raiders. 6.00 9News Sunday. 7.00 60 Minutes. 8.00 Boy George & Culture Club. 10.00 9News Late. 10.30 The First 48. 11.25 Love Cheats. 12.15 Tasman Trails. 1.05 GolfBarons. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. 4.30 CampByMe. 5.00 Today Early News. 5.30 Today. flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Home And Away. 2.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 4.10 Unbelievable Moments Caught On Camera. 5.00 Dr Harry's Animal Encounters. 6.00 Puppy School. 6.30 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. 7.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs. NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 News. 3.30 Offsiders. 4.00 Landline. 5.00 ABC News With Auslan. 5.30 ABC News Regional. 6.00 ABC Evening News. 6.30 Expanse: The Nannup Four. Final. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Insiders. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 ABC Nightly News. 9.25 Australian Story. 10.00 Late Programs.	10 10 10TV 6.00 Mass For You At Home. 6.30 Key Of David. 7.00 Joseph Prince: New Creation Church. 7.30 Silvia's Italian Masterclass. 8.00 10 Minute Kitchen. 8.30 My Market Kitchen. 9.00 Freshly Picked With Simon Toohey. 9.30 Luca's Key Ingredient. 10.00 The Chef's Garden. 10.40 MasterChef Australia. 1.00 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. 1.00 Deal Or No Deal. 2.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 3.00 The Finish Line. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 10 News+. 7.00 MasterChef Australia. 8.15 Watson. 9.15 FBI. 12.00 10 News+. 12.30 Home Shopping. drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Pooches At Play. 9.00 On The Fly. 9.30 Reel Action. 10.00 Navigating The World. 11.00 Escape Fishing With ET. 11.30 All 4 Adventure. 12.30 Tough Tested. 2.30 The Living Room. 3.30 JAG. 7.30 MOVIE: Forrest Gump. (1994) Tom Hanks. 10.15 Blue Bloods. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Late Programs. Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 The Baron. 1.30 Motorway Cops: Catching Britain's Speeders. 2.30 Explore. 2.45 MOVIE: We Of The Never Never. (1982) 5.30 Midsomer Murders. 7.30 David Attenborough's Mammals. 8.40 Paramedics. 9.40 Emergency. 10.40 Major Crimes. 11.40 Late Programs.	SBS SBS SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 4.35 Hitler: A Life In Pictures. 5.30 Underground Army. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Mary Celeste: Solving The Mystery. 8.25 Titanic: Secrets Of The Shipwreck. 10.15 Rock Legends. 10.45 FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. 11.15 How To Make It In Comedy. 12.10 Robson Green's Weekend Escapes. 12.45 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 1.15 MOVIE: Chuparrosa. (2024) 1.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group H. ESP v KSA. 4.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group G. BEL v IRN. comedy 6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 9.30 Family Feud. 1.00 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 Ridiculousness. 12.00 Home Shopping. VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 4.20 WorldWatch. 5.45 The Frontier. 6.40 Abandoned Engineering. 8.30 Cup Fever! 9.00 The Death Coast. 9.50 The Americans. 10.40 The Swiping Game. 11.00 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group D. TUR v PAR. Replay. 2.00 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.
7 9 7TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 The Hardacres. 11.30 You Can't Ask That. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Landline. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Deep End: The Scott Miller Story. New. 8.30 Four Corners. 9.20 Media Watch. 9.35 Planet America. 10.10 Stuff The British Stole. 10.40 ABC Late News. 10.55 The Business. 11.10 Rolf Harris: Primitime Predator. Final. 12.05 Late Programs. two 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 My Greek Odyssey. 2.00 Weekender. 2.30 Auction Squad. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Doc Martin. 8.30 A Touch Of Frost. 10.50 Air Crash Investigations. 11.50 Late Programs. Entertains 1.10pm Amazing Spaces. 2.00 ER. 2.45 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 The Outlaws. 9.30 Late Programs.	7 9 7TV 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 Time Is Money. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 9.10 The Rookie. 10.10 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 11.10 The Agenda Setters. 12.10 New Amsterdam. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise. mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 8.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 9.30 Adventure Gold Diggers. 10.30 Aussie Salvage Squad. 11.30 Late Programs. Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 8.45 Expedition With Steve Backshall. 9.35 Chopped Junior. 10.15 Kids Baking Championship. 11.00 Late Programs.	9 9 9TV 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Boy George & Culture Club. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Travel Guides. Return. 8.40 100% Footy. 9.40 9News Late. 10.10 Outback Opal Hunters. 11.10 Footy Classified. 12.10 Tipping Point. 1.05 Hello SA. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Global Shop. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. 4.30 A Current Affair. 5.00 Today Early News. 5.30 Today. flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 My Kitchen Rules. 12.15 Dodger. 2.15 Blow Up. 3.40 Farmer Wants A Wife. 5.00 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Law & Order. 8.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 9.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs. NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.25 Planet America. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.	10 10 10TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Entertainment Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Australia. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. Return. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 10 News: Lunchtime. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 MasterChef Australia. 8.40 Have You Been Paying Attention? 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 The Big Bang Theory. 11.30 Late Programs. drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 Building The Dream. 2.30 Bull. 3.30 JAG. 5.30 Bull. 6.30 Building The Dream. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 1.15 Home Shopping. Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Antiques Roadshow. 1.30 MOVIE: The 14. (1973) 3.40 MOVIE: Blue Murder At St Trinian's. (1957) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 The Madame Blanc Mysteries. Return. 9.40 The Good Karma Hospital. Return. 10.40 Major Crimes. 11.40 Late Programs.	SBS SBS SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group E. GER v CIV. Replay. 4.40 Patagonia. 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Robson Green's Weekend Escapes. 8.40 24 Hours In Emergency. 9.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 10.30 SBS World News Late. 11.00 FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. 11.30 Niagara Falls. 12.30 Robson Green's Weekend Escapes. 1.40 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 2.10 Bamay. 2.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group I. ARG v AUSria. 5.30 BBC News At Six. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.00 Family Feud. 10.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.30 Becker. 11.00 Frasier. 12.00 Lingo. 1.00 Friends. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 4.30 Becker. 5.00 The Big Bang Theory. 6.00 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs. VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 WorldWatch. 5.30 The Secret Genius Of Modern Life. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 Cup Fever! 9.00 Mysteries Unearthed With Danny Trejo. 9.50 The Americans. 10.45 Lee Lin Chin's Fashionista. 11.00 Late Programs.
7 9 7TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Planet America. 11.00 Rolf Harris: Primitime Predator. Final. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Death In Paradise. Final. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Stuff The British Stole. 8.30 Lucy Worsley's Victorian Murder Club. New. 9.30 I Was Actually There. 10.05 Compass. 10.35 ABC Late News. 10.50 The Business. 11.05 Four Corners. 11.50 Late Programs. two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Creek To Coast. 2.30 House Of Wellness. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Call The Midwife. 8.45 Inspector Morse. 11.05 Escape To The Country. 12.05 Late Programs. Entertains 2.00pm ER. 2.45 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Small Prophets. New. 9.00 Ground Up. 9.35 Late Programs.	7 9 7TV 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 Time Is Money. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 First Dates Australia. Return. 8.40 Doc. 9.40 House Of Wellness. 10.40 The Agenda Setters. 11.40 Happy's Place. 12.10 New Amsterdam. 1.10 The Outdoor Room With Jamie Durie. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise. mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 2.30 Adventure Gold Diggers. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Outback Truckers. 8.30 Rookie Truckers. 9.30 Outback Truckers. 10.30 Train Rescue Down Under. 11.30 Late Programs. Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.20 Young Sheldon. 8.40 Savage Builds. 9.25 MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". 9.50 BattleBots. 10.35 Late Programs.	9 9 9TV 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 MOVIE: A Royal Makeover. (2023) 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 The Hundred With Andy Lee. 8.30 Clarkson's Farm. 9.40 9News Late. 10.10 The Grand Tour. 11.25 Footy Classified. 12.15 Tipping Point. 1.01 Destination WA. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Building Ideas. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. 4.30 Late Programs. flix 6.00 It's Academic. 7.30 Get Arty. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 My Kitchen Rules. 12.00 Dodger. 2.00 Blow Up. 3.00 Frogger. 4.00 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 CSI: New York. 8.30 CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. 9.30 CSI: Miami. 10.30 CSI: New York. 11.30 Late Programs. NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.10 Four Corners. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.	10 10 10TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Entertainment Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Australia. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 10 News: Lunchtime. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 MasterChef Australia. 8.40 The Cheap Seats. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.10 Sports Tonight: The Weekly Kick Off. 10.40 The Big Bang Theory. 11.30 Late Programs. drama 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 Building The Dream. 2.30 Bull. 3.30 JAG. 5.30 Bull. 6.30 Building The Dream. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 Sports Tonight: The Weekly Kick Off. 11.45 Late Programs. Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Pointless. 11.30 My Favorite Martian. 12.00 Death In Paradise. 1.00 Antiques Roadshow. 1.30 MOVIE: Baxter! (1973) 3.40 MOVIE: On The Buses. (1971) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 New Tricks. 8.40 Agatha Christie's Marple. 10.40 Rizzoli & Isles. 11.40 Late Programs.	SBS SBS SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.40 Brooklyn Bridge: Engineering Masterpiece. 4.40 Patagonia. 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Who Do You Think You Are? 8.30 Insight. 9.30 Dateline. Return. 10.00 SBS World News Late. 10.30 Living Black. 11.00 FIFA World Cup 2026: Highlights Show. 11.30 The Negotiator. 12.20 Robson Green's Weekend Escapes. 12.55 Great British Railway Journeys. 2.05 Bamay. 2.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group K. POR v UZB. 5.30 Soccer. FIFA World Cup. Group L. ENG v GHA. comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.00 Family Feud. 10.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.30 Becker. 11.00 Frasier. 12.00 Lingo. 1.00 Friends. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 4.30 Becker. 5.00 The Big Bang Theory. 6.00 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs. VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 WorldWatch. 5.30 The Secret Genius Of Modern Life. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 Cup Fever! 9.00 Mysteries Unearthed With Danny Trejo. 9.50 The Americans. 10.45 Lee Lin Chin's Fashionista. 11.00 Late Programs.
7 9 7TV 6.00 News Breakfast. 9.00 ABC News Mornings. 10.00 Four Corners. 11.00 Restoration Australia. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 National Press Club Address. 1.35 Media Watch. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.00 Restoration Australia. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Gruen. 8.35 Guy Montgomery's Guy Mont Spelling Bee. 9.20 Race Around The World. 10.25 Planet America. 10.55 ABC Late News. 11.10 The Business. 11.30 You Can't Ask That. 12.00 Late Programs. two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Sydney Weekender. 2.30 Hornby: A Model Empire. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Heartbeat. 8.45 Foyle's War. 10.55 Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. 11.55 Late Programs. Entertains 1.15pm Elementary. 2.00 ER. 2.40 Abbott Elementary. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.45 Grand Designs NZ. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Beyond Paradise. 9.30 Late Programs.	7 9 7TV 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 			

CROSSWORD

No. 183



ACROSS

- 1 Metal disc under nut (6)
4 Suppress (8)
9 Out (5)
10 Lasting (9)
11 Intending (Colloq.) (5)
12 Pointless (9)

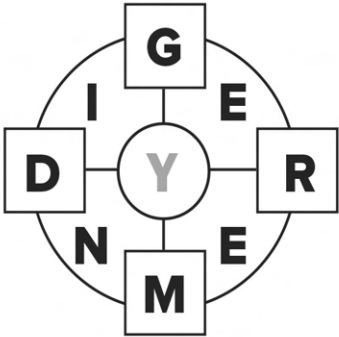
- 13 Coffee (8)
15 Peels (6)
16 Tabooed (6)
18 Scale of colour (8)
23 Without trust or belief (9)
24 Long-barrelled firearm (5)

9-LETTER

No. 183

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

Today's Aim:
12 words: Good
18 words: Very good
25 words: Excellent



SOLUTION



- 26 Point above focus of an earthquake (9)
27 Senseless (5)
28 Japanese game company (9)
29 Natural aptitude or skill (6)

DOWN

- 1 Argue noisily and angrily (7)
2 Twig offshoot (5)
3 Territory ruled by an Islamic monarch (7)
5 Outburst (6)
6 Bucking (7)
7 Grenade-wielding soldier (9)
8 Landed properties (7)
10 Leaves (5)
14 Divide into parts (9)
16 Ten plus five (7)
17 Excel (7)
19 Adhesive mixture (5)
20 Mediterranean island (7)
21 Most shy or submissive (7)
22 Impassioned (6)
25 SOS light (5)

WORDFIT

No. 093

3 LETTERS

- ACE
ADO
AGE
APT
ASK
ASS
AVO
CAN
CAP
CAR
DIM
EAT
EEL
EGG
ICE
OFF
PEA
PER
RAN
ROD
SUP
TAP
TAR
TEE

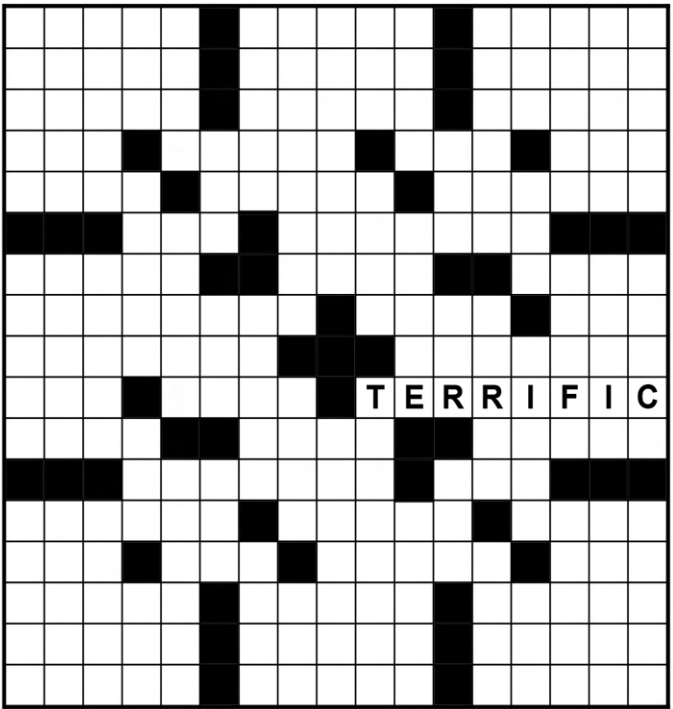
- SEEP
SICS
STAG
TAPS
TEST

5 LETTERS

- ABODE
ACRID
ADMIT
APPAL
APPLE
AROMA
ASSET
BEADS
BOARD
CASTE
CRAMS
DUNGS
EERIE
ELECT
ENEMA
ENSUE
ERROR
EVENS
EVENT
EVOKE
GALAS
GENES
GOODO
IMAGE
IRATE
KNEES
LEAFS
LEASE
LISTS

4 LETTERS

- DREW
ELMS
FLEE
ITCH
LEST
MORE
PARK
PORE
SECT



- MASTS
MATTE
NODES
ORBIT
PARSE
PAVES
PRESS
RAISE
RESET
RIDER
SCRAP
SHADE
SMOCK
SNEER

- STEER
STOPS
STORE
TIDAL
TORSO
VERSE
WIELD

- 7 LETTERS
APPAREL
DECLARE
ONESELF
PRESENT
REVERIE
SANDMEN

- 8 LETTERS
EMULATED
PARANOID
TELEWISE
TERRIFIC

- 6 LETTERS
COOEES
MAGPIE
PETROL
PICKLE

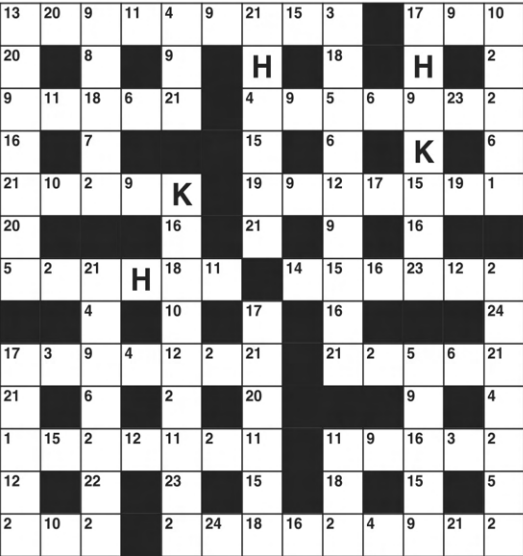
SOLUTION



CODEWORD

No. 133

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

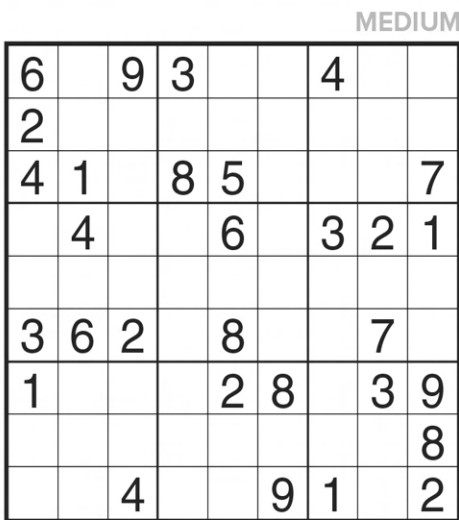
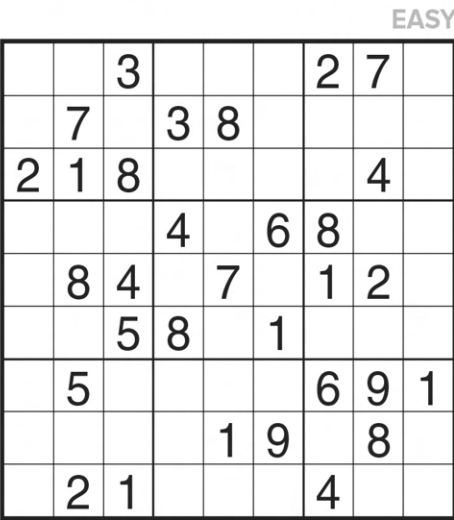


13 = Q, 14 = J, 15 = I, 16 = N, 17 = S, 18 = O, 19 = F, 20 = U, 21 = T, 22 = Z, 23 = G, 24 = X
1 = Y, 2 = E, 3 = C, 4 = R, 5 = M, 6 = P, 7 = V, 8 = B, 9 = A, 10 = W, 11 = D, 12 = L, 13 = Q, 14 = J, 15 = I, 16 = N, 17 = S, 18 = O, 19 = F, 20 = U, 21 = T, 22 = Z, 23 = G, 24 = X

SUDOKU

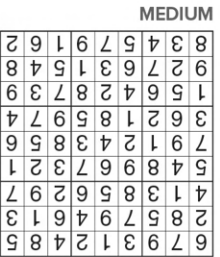
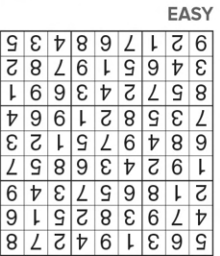
No. 183

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © pagemasters.

SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

- In which Australian city did cockroach racing originate?
- What colour is a polar bear's (pictured) fur?
- How many publishers rejected Frank Herbert's manuscript for *Dune*?
- What was the subject of the CIA's 'Project ARTICHOKE'?
- By how many degrees have oceans around Australia warmed since records began in 1910?
- And by how many degrees, on average, has our climate warmed since then?
- True or false: dolphins call each other by name?
- Which fingernail grows the fastest?
- Where does the name of Canberra's Tidbinbilla Nature Reserve come from?
- What were the first forms of life on earth?



ANSWERS: 1. Brisbane 2. Transparent 3. 23 4. Mind control 5. 1.5°C 6. 9 7. True 8. The nail on the middle finger 9. The Ngurnawal word 'Jedbinbilla', 'where boys become men' 10. Prokaryotes (bacteria)

WORD SEARCH

No. 093

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- AMATEUR RADIO
BAKING
CALLIGRAPHY
CHECKERS
CHESS
COOKING
CROCHET
DANCE
DARTS
DEBATE
DOMINOES
DRAWING
EXERCISE
GEOLOGY
HANDICRAFT

- HIKING
KNOT TYING
ORIGAMI
PAINTING
PHOTOGRAPHY
PILATES
READING
SCULPTING
SHOPPING
SUDOKU
TOYS
VOLLEYBALL
WRITING
YOGA

SECRET MESSAGE: A hobby a day keeps the old drums away

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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

For More Information call



Mb: 0428 635 994

AFTER A week of winter warmth, this coming week will be cooler and wetter. Rain Friday and Saturday still no frosts.

Grain market overview
US grain markets remain under pressure, especially corn and soybeans and tending lower, Chicago wheat down slightly about 1c to 587c/bushel as the market continues to balance improving Northern Hemisphere crop prospects against ongoing concerns around global wheat stocks and export demand.

Wheat values remain near recent lows with Black Sea competition continuing to weigh in. Domestic market:- Grain markets remain relatively stable with domestic consumer demand continuing to provide support despite ongoing weakness in international grain markets. Export demand remains selective while domestic homes continue to underpin nearby values. Grower selling remains measured, with many producers comfortable holding grain, given current seasonal conditions and pricing levels.

The stronger AUD slightly reduces export competitiveness and limits the benefit of offshore grain values flowing through to domestic pricing, however the currency remains below levels seen earlier in the season and continues to provide a degree of support to Australian exporters.

Market at a glance
WOOL.. Market continued its upward trend last week with the EMI closing 1979c/kg clean, gaining 15 cents, reaching its highest point since October 2018 and sitting 21c shy of the 2000c mark. Currency movements downwards helped. 25662 bales offered. Market opened strongly with Merino fleece with strength and low VM keenly sought after. This week just 21,720 bales being offered. Strength in medium Merino flc, xb and cardings suggests buyer confidence.
CATTLE.. CTLX 9th. 2154 head. Lighter and younger cattle went against the trend with weaner steers slipping 10c reaching 634c/kg, heifers to 528c/kg. Medium and heavy feeder steers up to 5c, 517c to 579c, heifers lifted 13c 488c to 553c/kg. Trade steers and heifers 489c to 513c/kg. Few grown steers and bullocks lifted 4c, 479c to 530c, heifers 10c better 450c and 492c/kg. Heavy cows firm 375c to 426c, leaner 2-score cows 8c to 12c stronger with help from restocker, 350c to 396c/kg.
SHEEP.. CTLX 10th 1750 sheep +195, 5050 lambs, +1505. Numbers lifted and quality excellent. Light lambs to restockers \$221 to \$255, feeders \$275 to \$290. Medium and heavy trade firm to \$5 easier, ave 1270c to 1295c/kg cwt. Heavy trade 23 to 24kg \$288 to\$322. Heavy lambs \$5 to \$6 cheaper, ave 1100c to 1240c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$302 to \$322, extra heavies \$322 to \$366.
Mutton numbers increased slightly and quality varied, prices easing \$5. Medium Merino ewes \$185 to \$230 or 905c/kg cwt. Heavy first cross ewes \$234 to \$340.

STOCK CLEARANCE SALE continues - poly pipe full range, Ag chem, fungicides, seeds and fertiliser, electric fencing, small packs (garden range), drench, dips, antiques, stands and cupboards, Phostoxin.



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Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT
Week ending June 12, 2026
AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$50/25	This Week M50/25	Last Sale \$49/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2752	2688	2726	+26	1658	+1094
18	2650	2611	2617	+33	1592	+1058
19	2428	2434	2424	+4	1509	+919
19.5	2340n	2322	2311	+29	-	-
20	-	22252	2205n	-	-	-
-21	-	-	-	-	-	-
28	850n	845	830n	+20	-	-
MC	1229n	1226n	1205n	+24	701n	+528

Long term confidence growing

THE WOOL MARKET continued to climb last week against the smallest three-centre offering since 2020.

On Wednesday’s opening the market performed strongly with all indicators recording positive results, particularly Fremantle coming back to sell after being absent last sale. Sydney and Melbourne only offered on day two with both centres indicators lift by 6 cents. The Southern gains were quite measured, whilst the Northern results were a little more erratic with some micron indicators performing well and others losing some ground. The finer Merino fleece end was well supported on Thursday, with the Carmichael catalogue having several sales to buyers that will send that wool to Europe, which is still very quiet on the processing front compared to traditional volumes. Skirtings continued to have weekly priced gains, as did both cardings and crossbreds. The only negative in US dollar terms the market fell on the back of the weakening Aussie dollar. Buyers feel the market is being helped greatly by the low offerings, with little opportunity for weakness in pricing due to pressure coming from the large Chinese processors’ buying needs. These top makers are very keen to promote the confidence

they have in the future of Australian Merino wool, and they were part of a China Industry Tour that brought together wool growers, brokers, exporters from Western Australia, as well as representatives from AWI The Woolmark Company. The consistent message from every company visited was the level of investment, the quality standards and the scale of their operations. Demand continues to grow as wool expands into a broader range of consumer products, with next-to-skin apparel, activewear and sportswear, casual clothing, outdoor performance garments, home furnishings and interiors, and cotton-wool blended products, a trend that has accelerated over the past three years generating additional demand for Australian Merino wool. The best information relayed from processors, manufactures and retailers was that current wool prices are sustainable and that the long-term outlook remains highly positive. Of the growers in the group, 10 of the 11 intended to grow their Merino wool business by 10 to 15%, with the 11th already at full capacity. This week is back to a two-centre offering of 21,720 bales, and Macwool and Carmichael catalogued 1122 bales for Tuesday.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 2584 head. Numbers similar, quality again mixed. More weaners, yearlings suited to feeders and restockers. Good run of heavy bullocks, most grown heifers were lighter. 400 cows penned, most in store condition. Market sold to stronger trends. Weaner steers lifted 20c to 676c for medium weights, heifers to 530c. A pen of light heifers around 120kg reached 685c/kg. Feeder steers up 20c to 25c, 500c to 584c/kg, heifers up 6c to 10c on medium weights, 20c better on heavies. most 468c and 548c/kg. Heavy trade limited, lifted by 15c to 25c, steers 507c to 520c, heifers 510c to 528c/kg. Grown steers and bullocks up 15c to 20c, most 490c to 520c/kg, heifers 460c to 480c/kg. Heavy cows firm to 6c dearer 390c to 430c/kg, leaner 2-score cows 10c stronger, plenty of interest from restockers, 357c to 404c/kg.
DUBBO SHEEP.. 16,402 head. Lamb numbers and quality lifted. Fewer store lambs, good runs of trade and heavy weights. Store lambs stronger, mixed sexed light \$120 to \$251. Light ewe \$242 to \$261, bare shorn joinable 2nd cross \$364 to \$385. Trade weights ended \$4 to \$6 cheaper, \$230 to \$293, or 1160c to 1200c/kg. 24 to 26kg \$280 to \$318 or 1195c/kg, heavy weights \$290 to \$354, ave 1140c/kg. Extra heavy \$325 to \$400, ave 1065c/kg. Merinos to \$298 or to 1140c/kg.
MUTTON.. Numbers lifted, quality platter, prices stronger. Merino ewes with 50mm skin to \$374, crossbreds to \$361, heavy Dorpers \$350. Most mutton 900c and 1000c/kg cwt.

WOOL.. Another positive week but rise in the headline indicators masks a few chinks in the armour that appeared as the week progressed. Sales held Wednesday/Thursday format last week due to Monday’s public holiday. NRI climbed 11 cents on opening day and added a further 6 cents on Thursday’s close. In US dollars the market lost 22 cents with the Aussie dollar down 1.65 cents against the US since the previous week. Individual micron indicator results were mixed from plus 50 cents to minus 10 cents. In a small offering this is not uncommon to see these varying results as the quality of the weekly selection, particularly in the finer microns comes into play. 24,823 bales were sold with a passed-in rate of 3.3%. Major buyers PJ Morris, Sequoia and Tianyu. Only two sales remain for the 2025/26 season. Average gain in prices for season to date is 66.8%. With the Western region not selling last week the national offering is expected to fall below 22,000 bales.
DUBBO STORE CATTLE.. 4150head. Market lifted \$80 and \$120 on average for steers and heifers. Light weaner steers to \$1250 or 702c/kg, medium weights 200 to 280kg \$1300 and \$1780. Angus steers ave 650c, Black Baldys 620c/kg. Heavy weaner steers to \$2230 for 375kg. Light weaner heifers \$480 to \$980 or 450c to 480c/kg. Medium weights \$1000 to \$1900, most 510c and 560c/kg. Heavy weaner heifers to \$2150 for just under 400kg. Limo cows, five years with young calf at foot reached \$3120, PTIC Angus heifers to \$2350.

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Walgett

IN NOVEMBER 2014 John Hunter from Mendooran shared ownership of Melbourne Cup winner Protectionist and on Saturday, a long way from Flemington, Delrico, part owned by Hunter, won the 1400 metres AgnVet Rural-Adama -Walgett Cup.

Appropriately, the 2001 Melbourne Cup won by the Sheila Laxon trained Ethereal was on the Lexus Australia wide tour and was viewed by many among the huge crowd at Walgett.

Trained until April by Chris Waller, the four-year-old gelding Delrico was having the third start since coming to Mendooran trainer Jane Clement.

Last early, Delrico (\$8) was worked through the field by Billy Cray and over the closing stages ran down Star Intrigue (Wendy Peel, \$6) to win the Cup by nearly a length with Blackhill Kitty (Hollie Hull, \$8) a distant third on the rain affected but safe track.

Jane Clement and apprentice Gabrielle Johnson have been in great form this season and they combined for yet another winner, Adviser in the 1000m Dubbo City Toyota Benchmark 50 Handicap Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Starting the \$3 favourite, Adviser led most of the way when beating Maybe Maureen (Nick Palmer, \$7) and Showtime Sassy (Jasmine Urquhart-Warren, \$5).

The Walgett committee had promoted the meeting extremely well and made a big effort to get racing underway including the use of a helicopter to help dry the track after rain earlier in the week.

There was a sigh of relief when officiating steward Xavier Dalton gave the go ahead and the crowd was already building to a big number when the Greg O’Neill, Nyngan trained Silent Drama (Dylan Stanley, \$5) in the opening race wore down the leaders to win the 900m Benabilla Auctions Maiden Plate from the second place dead heaters Barrieanna (Jasmine Urqahart-Warren, \$7) and Pie Chart (Jordie Thompson. \$3.40).

Formerly trained by Brett and Georgie Cavanaugh, Stuck In The Gorge won the 1400m Wickman Ryan Memorial Maiden Handicap for Coonamble trainer Stuart Canham.

Non claiming apprentice Zoe Hunt had her mount second early before Stuck In The Gorge (\$5.50 to \$4.60) took over and raced to a near four lengths win over Windsor Road (Nick Palmer, \$9) and C’mon Donkey (Angel Brennan, \$4.40).

Cup winning jockey Billy Cray had earlier won the 1300m P & J Harris & Sons Class 1 Handicap on the Nikki Pollock, Scone trained Stolen Show (\$4 equal fav) which led all the way and bolted in over 11 lengths clear of Bravalante (Leanne Boyd, \$6) and Taxonomy Hollie Hull, \$4).

Wrapping up a highly successful meeting, the Connie Greig, Dubbo trained The Bentley (Hollie Hull, \$5) from midfield overhauled Cooma Hut (Jasmine Urquhart-Warren, \$3.50) in the last stride with Hardy (Gabrielle Johnston, \$3.20 fav) third in the 1600m Walgett District Sporting Club Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Racing on Saturday at Coonabarabran (TAB) and Talmoi Picnics and on Monday June 22 at Narromine (TAB).

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Golfing News Ladies fail in Mudgee return pennants

AN EVENT coming up is the Joe Ryan Mowing RED TEE Challenge to be played over three rounds with best two rounds to count.

Challenge dates are June 27, July 25 and August 15. WDLGA Pennants ladies ventured to Mudgee in a return match after claiming a 3 and 2 victory in Wellington. However, it was the complete reverse in Mudgee, going down by the same score, 3 and 2. It will come down to a countback to see if the Ladies will play on. Last Saturday’s Individual Stableford A grade winner, Jono Smith, cleared out on the field with 37pts. Runner-up was Kurt Cusack with another sub-par round, 36pts. B grade winner was one of the early rises, Brad Conn with 36pts, while runner-up with 35pts was Peter Neuenhaus. Prize winners were John Donnelly, Rod Miller, Zac McManus, Peter Holden 34pts; Rod Pedron, Matthew Conn, James Armstrong, Denise Haesler 33pts;

Liam Conn 32pts on c/b. Nearest the pin on 3rd John Gersbach, 8th Brad Conn, 14th Joe Ryan, 16th Marie Cornish. NTP in two-shots on 17th was Kurt Cusack. Longest drives went to Mitchell Cusack in A grade and Rod Pedron in B grade. The Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by a visitor Stuart Cosgrove with 20pts, he saved a well-known morning golfer. Wednesday’s Individual Stableford winner was Denise Haesler who played really well to finish with 37pts. Runner-up with 35pts was Pauline Potts. Thursday’s Individual Stableford winner was Rod Irwin with 35pts. Runner-up and just pipped at the post on 34pts was Paul Hannelly. Prize winner was James Armstrong 31pts. Diggers Golf Club results from Sunday’s 4BBB had Peter

Neuenhaus and Rachel Wykes claim the winner’s prize with a massive 46pts. Runners-up were Neale McCabe and Barry Bowman with one point behind on 45pts. NT Pon 14th Peter Holden, Neale McCabe, 8th John Disney, Kathy Martin. J and B Cup, Matchplay Championships final date still to be finalised. Semi-Finals of the Kiss Trophy now see’s Bryan Kiss taking on John Gersbach while Gary Cusack defeated Adam Ryan 2 and 1. Matches to be finalised by June 20. Round 1 matches of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy are to be played by July 11. There are no more PREFERRED LIES. This Saturday’s event is a 4BBB Stableford plus the Semi-Finals of the Kiss Trophy. **19th Hole**

Government to introduce commonsense medicinal cannabis driving reforms

THE STATE Government will introduce laws to Parliament to create a more commonsense approach for people using lawfully prescribed medicinal cannabis, while maintaining strong road safety protections. Under the reforms, drivers taking prescribed medicinal cannabis containing THC will no longer be automatically penalised under the current drug presence offence framework in certain circumstances. The Government recognises these are significant changes and will implement them cautiously, with strong safeguards and road safety protections built into every stage of the new system. There are around one million medicinal cannabis users in Australia, with up to a third (over 300,000) estimated in NSW and growing, with the number of cannabis medicines dispensed each month in NSW almost doubling in a 12-month period. To be eligible for the new system,

drivers will be required to enrol as a registered medicinal cannabis user with Transport for NSW, provide proof of a valid prescription and complete an online education program about cannabis and driving safety. The changes will only apply to NSW drivers on an unrestricted licence and excludes L or P plate drivers and commercial drivers. The Government will introduce a measured three-strike approach for registered medicinal cannabis users, recognising some drivers may test positive to THC despite using their medication lawfully and responsibly. Under the new system, registered medicinal cannabis users will still be roadside drug tested. If a driver returns a positive roadside test, they will continue to receive an immediate 24-hour driving ban while the sample is sent for laboratory testing. If the laboratory result shows THC below the maximum threshold there will be no charge or further action.

Warning about state’s big driving reform

Story by Tia Clarkson-Pascoe NEWS Wire CLINICIANS ACROSS NSW have raised alarm bells about the government’s new driving policy which will stop drivers with trace amounts of cannabis in their system being penalised. Under Labor’s plans, registered medicinal cannabis users will avoid drug-driving charges even if they test positive for the active ingredient THC. People with prescriptions who test positive will still be prevented from driving for 24 hours, but if their saliva has fewer than 50 nanograms per millilitre of THC they will not face conviction for their first two offences, under a three-strikes rule. The state’s Liberals and Nationals have called for the change to be abandoned, and a co-signed letter from heads of trauma in major NSW hospitals and other specialists have said the states permitted 50ng/ml limit “is not endorsed by any Australian or international peak clinical body. “It is an administrative convenience that has been given the appearance of scientific authority it does not possess”. It comes after NSW opposition leader Kellie Sloane said the policy would put people’s lives at risk. “When experts are warning that this policy could cost lives, pressing ahead regardless would be an extraordinary act of recklessness,” she said. “The Government should stop pretending this is evidence-based reform, withdraw the three-strikes

policy and work with clinicians, road safety experts and patient groups on a system that protects both road users and medicinal cannabis patients.” Shadow minister for roads Mark Coure said the government should immediately adopt the recommendations in the letter. “What more does Labor need to convince them this is a dangerous policy that puts at risk the safety of every road user,” he said. “Those prescribed medicinal cannabis also deserve a legal system that protects them and not one that can’t tell if they took their medication two hours ago or 12.” Federal NSW Greens senator David Shoebridge said charging prescribed users with trace amounts of THC in their system was “bloody stupid”. “I can’t believe that getting these reforms has taken years ... This is a tiny little commonsense reform,” he said. “We have drug-driving laws that should say, absolutely, fundamentally, if you’re impaired by drugs, then you should not be allowed anywhere near a steering wheel. “And what this says is, if you’ve got tiny amounts of cannabis in your system, which all the expert evidence says cannot be impairing your driving, and you have a prescription for medicinal cannabis, then we’re not going to take your licence off you.”

Auditor-General report exposes failures in water reform agenda

AFTER THREE years of mounting legislation, regulations and compliance obligations, the Auditor-General has found the State Government cannot demonstrate whether its water reforms are delivering meaningful benefits. The report found that the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW) has not adequately assessed the cumulative impact of water reforms introduced since 2017, and cannot demonstrate whether compliance and enforcement measures have improved the sustainable management of non-urban water use across NSW. Rather than simplifying the system, the Auditor-General found that successive reforms have contributed to a regulatory framework so complex that staff across all three water agencies - DCCEEW, the Natural Resources Access Regulator (NRAR) and WaterNSW - have struggled to consistently interpret and apply water rules.

NRAR itself reported that most instances of non-compliance are the result of water users misunderstanding increasingly complex water laws. The report also identified significant deficiencies in the data and information systems underpinning water regulation, finding that outdated systems, poor data quality and limited access to critical information continue to impede enforcement efforts. Importantly, the Auditor-General found these deficiencies limit agencies’ ability to identify risks, detect breaches, monitor compliance and evaluate the effectiveness of the broader water management framework. Shadow Minister for Water Steph Cooke said the findings validate concerns repeatedly raised by the NSW Nationals and Liberals, and stakeholders across the irrigation sector. “For the past three years, the Minns Labor Government has continued to introduce

new legislation, new regulations, new reporting requirements and tougher penalties, yet this report makes clear they cannot demonstrate whether any of it is actually working,” Ms Cooke said. “Instead of fixing the underlying problems in the system, Labor has added layer upon layer of complexity to a framework that was already difficult to navigate. “The Auditor-General has found that even government agencies are struggling to consistently interpret and apply the rules.” Ms Cooke said if regulators can’t navigate the system with confidence, how can the Government expect water users to do so? The report was equally critical of NRAR’s ability to demonstrate its effectiveness, finding the regulator lacks adequate performance measurement and reporting frameworks and has poor governance over key compliance and enforcement data. “The findings were particularly concerning given Labor’s decision to significantly

increase penalties under the Water Management Legislation Amendment (Stronger Enforcement and Penalties) Act 2025,” Ms Cooke said. “While Labor has focused on increasing penalties and expanding regulatory powers, it has failed to address the fundamental issues identified by the Auditor-General. “The people of regional NSW deserve a water management system that is accountable and transparent, not an ever-growing maze of red tape.” Ms Cooke called on the Minns Labor Government to implement the Auditor-General’s recommendations, including a comprehensive review of the cumulative impact of water reforms and action to address long-standing deficiencies in water data and IT systems. “The Government must stop measuring success by the volume of legislation it passes and start demonstrating real outcomes for irrigators, regional communities and the environment,” she said.

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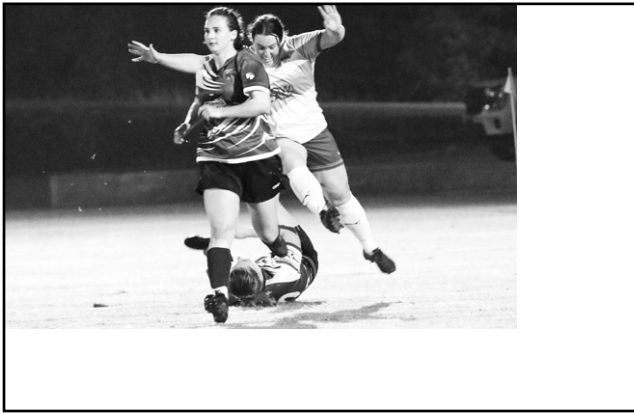
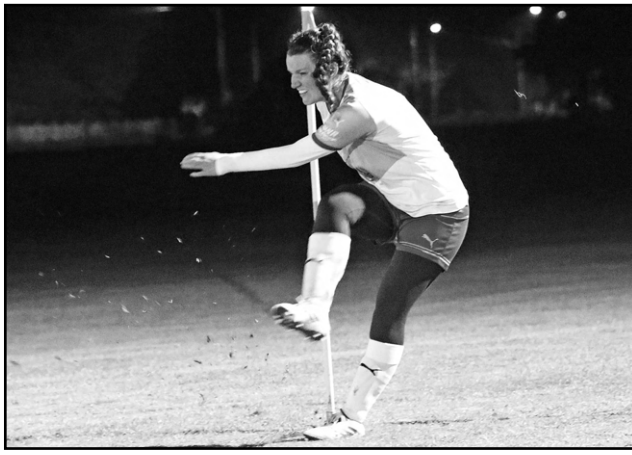
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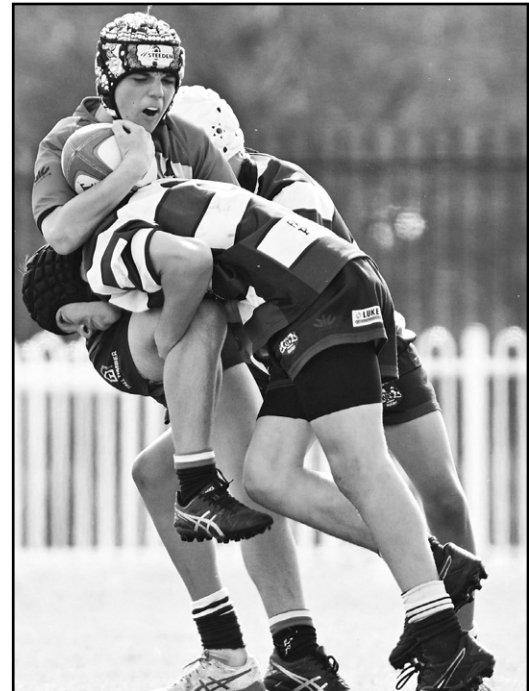
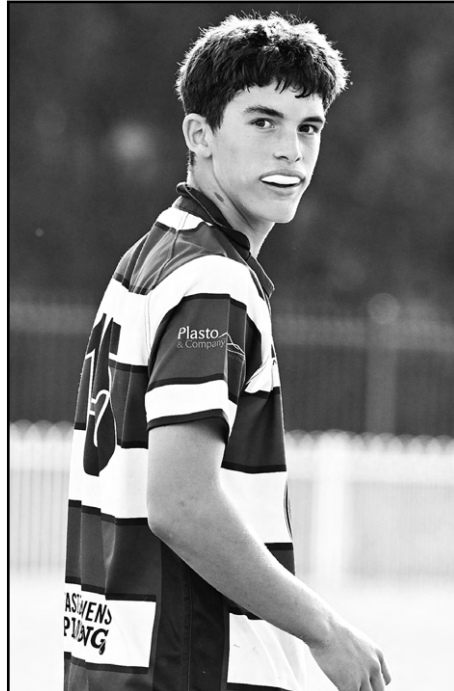
Wellington Warriors

Jo Ivey photos



REDBACKS v MUDGEE

Carmen Gain photos



Wellington women dominating Over 30s

WELLINGTON WARRIORS Women's Over 30s side is proving to be one of the success stories of the 2026 season, making an immediate impact in their first year competing in the Dubbo competition.

The team attracted strong interest before the season began, with players returning from retirement, others preparing to hang up the boots, and some stepping onto the soccer field for the very first time.

What has developed is a close-knit and supportive group that has quickly become one of the competition's standout teams.

Currently sitting at the top of the ladder, the ladies have exceeded expectations and continue to showcase the strength of women's football in Wellington.

Last Friday night, the Warriors took on East Dubbo United FC and delivered an impressive 3-0 victory.

The team displayed outstanding teamwork and skill, linking together a series of quality passes and attacking plays throughout the match.

Sara Darney led the charge in front of goal, finding the back of the net twice, while Jane Pearce added a spectacular goal of her own.

Although the forwards enjoyed success, it was the tireless work in midfield from Hannah Haines that caught the attention of her teammates, earning her the Players' Player award.

On Sunday, Wellington's First Grade Women faced a strong and polished Dubbo Newtown side.

Despite suffering a 6-1 defeat, the scoreline did not fully reflect the contest.

Wellington enjoyed significant periods of possession in

the opposition half and created several promising opportunities.

The Warriors' goal came from a well-worked move that started deep in defence before Ciara Ryan timed her run perfectly and calmly slotted home to put Wellington on the scoreboard.

Ryan continues to impress in just her second season with the club and was deservedly awarded First Grade Women's Players' Player for her performance.

Meanwhile, Wellington's Second Grade Men were involved in one of the most exciting matches of the weekend, producing a remarkable second-half comeback against RSL to secure a thrilling 5-5 draw.

The match was played at a high intensity, with both sides producing quality football and plenty of attacking flair.

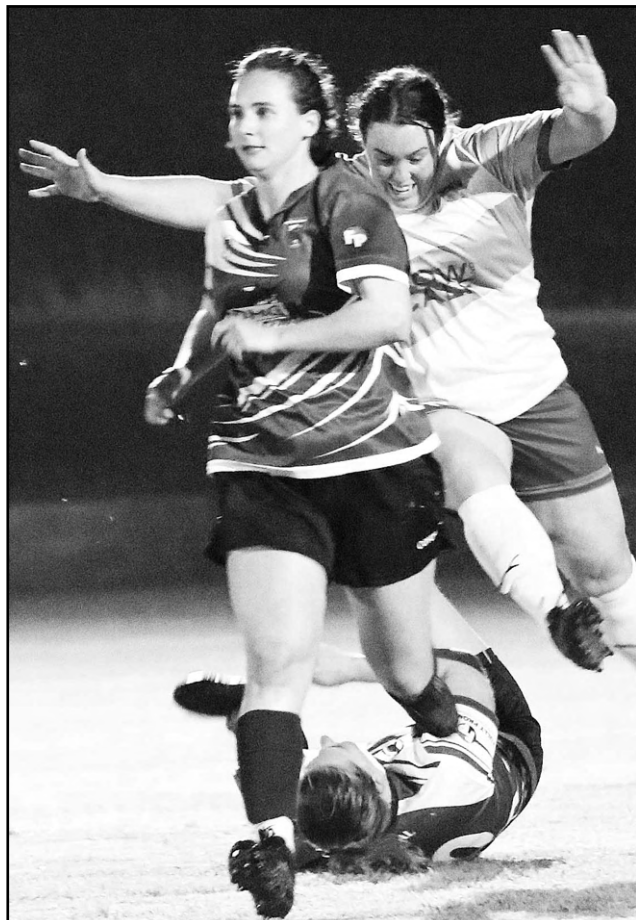
Wellington's determination and teamwork shone through as they fought their way back into the contest.

For his outstanding contribution and work rate throughout the match, Ethan Norcott was voted Players' Player by his teammates.

With both the women's and men's squads showing plenty of promise, the future looks bright for Wellington Warriors Football Club as the season continues.

Jessica Chown

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